

Creating Remoting channels at runtime

When a Web-based Flex application communicates with an application server that supports Flash Remoting (known as the Remoting Service in LiveCycle Data Services and BlazeDS), it typically uses a channel definition with dynamic expressions that evaluate at runtime to the location of the server from which the application was downloaded. This is the default my-amf channel delivered with BlazeDS:

```

• <channel-definition id="my-amf"
• class="mx.messaging.channels.AMFChannel">
• <endpoint
• url="{server.name}:{server.port}/{context.root}/
• messagebroker/amf" class="flex.messaging.endpoints.AMFEnd-
point"/>
• </channel-definition>

```

The `<endpoint>` element's url attribute uses dynamic expressions to evaluate the server name and port and the context root of the hosting instance of BlazeDS. This approach doesn't work with desktop applications deployed with AIR, because the concept of "the current application server" doesn't have any meaning in a desktop application. Instead, you must provide the explicit location of the server-based application to which Remoting requests should be sent at runtime.

A conclusion on Adobe AIR

In addition to the features described in this chapter, AIR applications can accomplish the following tasks that aren't possible with Flex Web applications:

- Full screen and spanned monitor display
- Integration with native visual components such the operating system's window and menu systems
- Creation of applications with transparency that serve as widgets
- Reading and writing files and folders on the local file system
- Persisting data in SQLite, a local database embedded in the runtime
- Interacting with the system clipboard, including drag-and-drop to and from AIR applications and the OS
- Synchronization of data managed on the server by LiveCycle Data Services
- Access to all network services supported by the Flex framework

The subject of building and deploying AIR-based desktop applications is worthy of an entire Fast Track, and in fact there are many such books available. 